

Princess Nada and the Secret of Smiles

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Princess Nada and the Secret of Smiles

Summary

One morning, every smile in the kingdom seems to have disappeared. Princess Nada and her friend Piko set off to find the mysterious Flower of Joy. Along the way, they discover that happiness grows when people listen, share, and help one another.

Chapter 1 — The Morning Without Laughter

In the Kingdom of a Thousand Smiles, the fountains sang, the birds whistled, and even the toast seemed to crackle with happiness.

But that morning, something was wrong.

— Good morning, Mr. Sun! called Nada from her balcony.

The sun stayed hidden behind a little gray cloud.

In the courtyard, the baker forgot to make his dough dance. The children played without bursting into laughter. The Great Bell of Smiles remained silent.

Piko rolled in like a fluffy cotton ball.

— I tried my funniest face, he announced. Even the mirror did not laugh!

Nada looked at the crystal bell.

— Grandmother used to say it shined because of the Flower of Joy at the top of the hill.

— Then let us go say hello to it! replied Piko.

Nada picked up her satchel.

— And let us find out why it has fallen asleep.

Chapter 2 — The Whispering Garden

In the Whispering Garden, the giant flowers were all talking at once.

— This way!

— No, over here!

— Take the path that smells like strawberries!

Nada almost covered her ears. Then she noticed a tiny violet gently moving its petals.

— Let us listen to the one speaking the softest, she suggested.

The violet whispered,

— The right path is hidden beneath the silver leaves.

Piko blew gently. The leaves parted, revealing a sparkling path.

— You were right, Nada! he exclaimed.

Nada thanked the little flower.

— A gentle voice can give the greatest answer.

Chapter 3 — The Flowers' Picnic

Farther along, the garden flowers looked hungry. They leaned their blossoms toward Nada's basket.

— We have honey cookies, said Piko. But only four!

Nada broke each cookie into several pieces.

— When we share, there may be less in our hands, but much more in our hearts.

The flowers happily nibbled the crumbs and immediately stood tall again.

One daisy sneezed.

— Ah-choo... petals!

A shower of golden pollen landed all over Piko's nose.

— Now I look like a breaded cloud! he joked.

Nada burst into laughter. The flowers laughed too. Their joy created a glowing map in the air.

Chapter 4 — The River of Bubbles

The map led the friends to a turquoise river. Thousands of bubbles hid the stepping stones.

— I could just jump across, suggested Piko.

— Or we could think together, replied Nada.

She noticed that some bubbles stayed perfectly still. They were probably resting above the stones.

Piko blew a gentle breeze. The bubbles drifted away, revealing a colorful path.

— One idea and one breath—what a team! he said.

Carefully, they crossed from stone to stone.

When they reached the other side, Nada felt a warm sense of pride.

— Courage is not rushing ahead with your eyes closed. It is moving forward with care.

Chapter 5 — The Flower of Joy

At the top of the hill, a giant sunflower lay asleep. Its golden petals were folded shut.

— Flower of Joy, why do you not shine anymore? asked Nada.

A tired voice replied,

— No one came to share their happy moments with me anymore... and I am very thirsty.

There was only one small sip of water left in Nada's flask.

— It is yours, she decided.

Piko shook his tiny rain bell. A gentle sprinkle of rain fell onto the roots.

The sunflower straightened up. Its petals opened like a hundred little suns.

— You gave me water, said the flower, but you also gave me your time and your kindness. That is the true secret of smiles.

Chapter 6 — The Festival of a Thousand Smiles

A golden light crossed the sky and reached the castle.

DING! DONG!

The Bell of Smiles began to sing once more.

Across the kingdom, children laughed again, the baker twirled his dough, and the sun finally came out from behind its cloud.

That evening, a grand celebration filled the gardens.

— Princess Nada, how did you bring our smiles back? asked a little girl.

Nada looked at Piko, the flowers, and all the people gathered together.

— I did not bring them back by myself. We awakened them by listening to one another, sharing what we had, and helping each other.

Piko raised a paw.

— And thanks to my famous Breaded Cloud Technique!

Everyone burst into laughter.

Conclusion

From that day on, every resident visited the Flower of Joy to share a little happy moment: a game shared with a friend, a bird they had spotted, or a fear they had overcome.

Nada realized that the happiest days are not the ones when everything is perfect. They are the days when everyone brings a little light into someone else's life.

And in the Kingdom of a Thousand Smiles, the Bell of Smiles never stayed silent for very long again.

Moral

Happiness grows when we listen to others, share what we have, and join our strengths with kindness.

Questions to Discuss with Your Child

1. Why does Princess Nada choose to listen to the little violet?
2. How do Nada and Piko discover the stepping stones across the river?
3. What is the true secret of smiles?

Activities

Creative Activity

Make your own Flower of Joy using colored paper. On each petal, write or draw something that makes you happy.

Drawing Idea

Draw Nada and Piko visiting a new magical place somewhere in the kingdom.

Imagination Challenge

Imagine that the Bell of Smiles says something every time it rings. What would it say today?